

About the Responsibility Governance Standard

(RGS)

Canonical Definition

Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) defines the structural conditions under which responsibilities remain assignable, identifiable, traceable, governable, accountable, reconstructable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility lifecycle.

RGS governs responsibility.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine who was responsible, what they were responsible for, when responsibility existed, how responsibility was assigned, whether responsibility remained valid, and whether responsibility was fulfilled.

What This Standard Is

RGS is a parent standard of the Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™).

It governs:

- responsibility governance
- responsibility assignment
- responsibility ownership
- responsibility scope
- responsibility validity
- responsibility traceability
- responsibility accountability
- responsibility fulfillment

RGS establishes the governance layer responsible for determining who was obligated to act within a governance environment.

What This Standard Is Not

RGS is not:

- an authority standard
 - a delegation standard
 - a validation standard
 - an escalation standard
 - a capability standard
 - a control standard
 - an oversight standard
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RGS does not govern who may act.

RGS governs who must act.

Why This Standard Exists

Many governance failures occur not because authority is missing, but because responsibility becomes unclear.

Examples include:

- unclear ownership
- responsibility gaps
- overlapping responsibilities
- abandoned responsibilities
- contractor-chain ambiguity
- supervisory uncertainty
- Human-AI responsibility confusion
- unfulfilled obligations

In many investigations, disputes, audits, incidents, and operational failures, the central question eventually becomes:

"Who was responsible?"

RGS exists because responsibility governance has become a distinct governance space.

Core Insight

Authority grants the right to act. Responsibility creates the obligation to act.

Operational Architecture Space

RGS defines the operational architecture space for:

- responsibility governance
 - responsibility assignment
 - responsibility ownership
 - responsibility boundaries
 - responsibility traceability
 - responsibility accountability
 - responsibility fulfillment
 - responsibility continuity
 - contractor responsibility governance
 - Human-AI responsibility governance
 - agent responsibility governance
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This space exists because governance depends upon the ability to identify responsibility before accountability can be established.

RGS governs whether responsibility remains valid.

General Use Case 1 — Multi-Layer Contractor Environment

Scenario

A company hires a contractor, the contractor hires a subcontractor, and the subcontractor hires a temporary worker who performs operational activities.

Application

RGS governs responsibility assignments across the entire operational chain and determines who was responsible for specific obligations, decisions, controls, and outcomes.

Result

Governance gains visibility into responsibility ownership across complex operational structures.

General Use Case 2 — Human-AI Operational Environment

Scenario

A human supervisor, orchestration platform, AI agent, and automated execution system collectively participate in operational decision-making.

Application

RGS governs responsibility allocation and determines which actor was responsible for specific actions, approvals, controls, and outcomes.

Result

Governance gains visibility into responsibility ownership across intelligent operational systems.

Architectural Position

Within AGA™, RGS serves as the sixth foundational governance layer.

The architecture progresses:

**Relationship → Authority → Authority Delegation → Authority
Validation → Authority Escalation → Responsibility → Capability →
Control → Oversight → Evidence → Accountability → Consequence**

RGS governs who was obligated to act before governance evaluates capability, control, oversight, accountability, or consequences.

Closing Definition

**Responsibility governance is not the assignment of authority.
Responsibility governance is the governed process through which obligations, duties, ownership, operational expectations, and required actions remain identifiable, traceable, enforceable, and reconstructable throughout operational reality.**

**Governance cannot function if responsibility cannot be identified.
Before accountability can be established, responsibility must first be understood, governed, and preserved.**

Related Documents

→ [Responsibility Governance Standard - \(RGS\)](#)

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Canonical Source

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